

Prahl Portfolio Work Log - October 7, 2026

Compiled summary for Wednesday, October 7, 2026 - focus: continuing the PrahL.dev Portfolio after the October 5 interactive UI/UX Philosophy, four-stage workflow, and Core Beliefs record; independently verifying the United States Eastern date; running the customary project reader; extracting and studying all forty-nine pre-existing Portfolio PDF worklogs; refining the slimmest portrait hero quote, profile, device, and proof-stat composition; expanding the UI/UX Philosophy data from five to eight decisions; rebuilding its portrait presentation around full-card underlays, device-specific media, and large background numerals; replacing the former wide-screen decision arrangement with responsive one-, two-, and three-column carousel states; adding click-and-hold arrow navigation and complete inactive-stack interaction; introducing a Motion-powered desktop 3D perspective treatment; correcting transform-origin, hit-testing, spacing, and navigation-state defects; enlarging and centering simplified background numerals; extending the philosophy subtitle; maintaining the detached local Next.js preview; validating TypeScript, routes, reduced motion, interaction, and responsive geometry; documenting committed source states 137edaf, 4e17af1, 627dfd4, and 71277ce; refreshing the Portfolio project snapshot; and generating the October 7 Portfolio PDF worklog.

Generated in continuity with the established Prahl Portfolio daily worklog cadence: compact opening summary, source-material section, baseline section, goal list, grouped work-completed sections, committed-source sequence, validation section, files-touched list, follow-up context, and output-artifact close.

This artifact intentionally covers Portfolio work performed after portfolio_worklog_october5.pdf and its documentation commit 6ab3c6b. The application work is represented by four October 7 commits on main, matching origin/main at 71277ce before this documentation pass. Together they changed the landing hero proof presentation, shared proof-stat measurement, UI/UX decision data, the reusable UI/UX showcase component, and global responsive styling. No application-source edit, commit, push, manual Hostinger synchronization, or production-release action was performed as part of generating this PDF; the documentation deltas are the refreshed portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt file and this root-level October 7 worklog.

Source Materials Reviewed

- Verified the United States Eastern date through an independent UTC-04:00 time query, which reported October 7, 2026 at 10:59:58 PM. A local TZ=America/New_York check immediately afterward reported Wednesday, October 7, 2026 at 11:00:11 PM EDT (-0400). Both checks remained on October 7, so the filename and title use Wednesday, October 7 rather than an execution-host or UTC date.
- Ran ./read_project.sh from /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio and regenerated portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt before composing this record, preserving the established source, asset, configuration, Git, PDF-inventory, and workflow-context capture practice.
- Extracted and studied all forty-nine pre-existing root-level Portfolio PDF worklogs with pdftotext and pdfinfo: fifteen July records, fifteen August records, fifteen September records, and four October records through portfolio_worklog_october5.pdf. Before this artifact, the archive contained 282 PDF pages and 137,656 extracted words.
- Compared every record for month-name filenames, non-zero-padded day numbers, same-day Part suffix behavior, title and opening-summary construction, source and baseline framing, goal lists, grouped technical bullets, validation language, files-touched treatment, follow-up continuity, output-artifact closure, and dated page footers.
- Used October 5 as the direct chronological baseline because it documented the five-decision interactive compact philosophy selector and the final workflow/Core Beliefs state. Used October 4 for the original reusable decision showcase, October 2 and October 1 for the current landing hero, Work Space, navigation, and Cinerific context, and the July-through-September archive for the mature document voice and density.
- Checked representative early, middle, and latest PDFs visually and inspected the full archive metadata. The mature artifact convention remains unencrypted US Letter at 612 x 792 points, PDF 1.4, Helvetica and Helvetica-Bold, dense black-on-white technical copy, Codex metadata, and a repeated title-and-page footer.
- Reviewed commits 137edaf, 4e17af1, 627dfd4, and 71277ce through git log, git show, commit bodies, file statistics, range diffs, and final source. The range after the October 5 documentation commit changed five tracked files with 1,746 insertions and 163 deletions; main and origin/main both resolved to 71277ce2a8aa36241e59bf1b4f816881290e7888 before PDF generation.
- Reviewed app/ProofStats.tsx, app/UiUxDecisionShowcase.tsx, app/page.tsx, app/globals.css, the refreshed project snapshot, the current Alla Vostra and Cinerific media mappings, and all locally served Portfolio routes relevant to the October 7 work.

Baseline Status Before October 7 Work

- The October 5 state had converted UI/UX Philosophy into a five-decision experience with real Alla Vostra and Cinerific media, project links, a focused compact control, a complete bottom rail, and a measured device connector. Desktop still retained the earlier wide left/right decision composition rather than a

unified responsive carousel.

- The slimmest portrait hero still placed the quote, profile portrait, and nametag in a less deliberate shared arrangement, while vertical spacing between the service proof panel, device stack, quote/profile region, and four proof statistics required further balancing.
- The proof-stat strip remained constrained by the standard landing content margins. Its labels could wrap awkwardly at narrow portrait widths, and green values and gray labels did not yet share the requested four equal full-width horizontal zones and common left edge.
- The philosophy selector still represented five decisions and relied on the earlier focused-control plus bottom-row model. It did not provide the eight-entry sequence, placeholder states, title bridge, full-card visual underlay, oversized split numerals, or the final carousel navigation system.
- Large-card descriptions used the earlier paragraph treatment. Device frames, copy hierarchy, active/inactive surfaces, and background numbering had not yet been normalized into the final one-, two-, and three-column responsive system.
- No desktop 3D scene existed. Inactive neighbors were flat responsive columns without perspective rotation, Motion layout interpolation, inner-edge transform pivots, reduced-motion handling, or whole-stack click capture.

Goals for October 7

- Center the slimmest portrait quote and profile identity, place the portrait/nametag on its own row, and rebalance only the intended portrait gaps without disturbing broader breakpoints.
- Allow all four proof statistics to use equal horizontal real estate across the narrow viewport, align each label to its value, and measure authored label rows so edge overflow is prevented instead of hidden.
- Expand UI/UX Philosophy to eight ordered decisions, strengthen its card-based visual language, and preserve real project imagery, device frames, description hierarchy, and project attribution.
- Replace the obsolete landscape-specific philosophy layout with responsive one-, two-, and three-column carousel variants aligned to the existing case-study breakpoints.
- Add accessible directional navigation, click-and-hold progression, stable active/inactive styling, uniform card heights, and full inactive-stack click targets without allowing navigation-state flashes or nested links to escape prematurely.
- Use the existing Motion dependency and CSS 3D capabilities to create a convincing desktop-only perspective carousel while keeping portrait/tablet layouts flat and keeping future text, image, spacing, and alignment edits straightforward.
- Refine square selector/header geometry, large background numeral scale and placement, philosophy copy, subtitle language, and final responsive typography, then validate the accepted state against live browser measurements.

Work Completed - Slim Portrait Hero and Proof Statistics

- Centered the quote block in the narrowest portrait hero and moved the profile portrait plus Martin Prahli nametag onto a dedicated row beneath it. The change is isolated to the slimmest portrait presentation rather than altering the wider landing composition.
- Rebalanced the portrait sequence between the service proof panel, quote, identity row, device previews, and statistics. The accepted spacing doubled the pre-quote interval, reduced the below-nametag interval, and then trimmed the larger Vercel-stack-to-three-years region without changing unrelated landscape spacing.
- Allowed the four proof-stat items to extend through the side margins in portrait mode and assigned equal horizontal zones. Full-Stack Mastery, Quality GitHub Commits, Real-Time Project Worklogs, and Shipped Mob/Web Products therefore retain equal real estate even when their labels have different lengths.
- Reversed the initial alignment interpretation so the gray labels follow the green value edge, then kept both value and label content aligned consistently within each quarter rather than centering one layer independently.
- Expanded ProofStats into a client-side measured component. It records each rendered value width, calculates usable label space, waits for document fonts, listens to window and ResizeObserver changes, and selects one-, two-, or three-line label modes from actual text measurements.
- Added explicit authored three-line handling for Full-Stack Mastery and visually hidden complete labels for assistive technology. The visible measured rows can change without fragmenting the accessible phrase.
- Committed the portrait and statistics pass as 137edaf, including the refreshed snapshot context that preceded the later philosophy work.

Work Completed - Portrait Philosophy Card Redesign

- Turned the focused philosophy control into a full-card underlay while preserving its foreground eyebrow, description, device frame, contextual copy, and project label. The active card became the visual surface instead of a detached oversized button below a separate content region.

- Introduced a separate title bridge between selector navigation and the large card, then connected the top controls visually while protecting them from later underlay expansion. The lower connector was removed and its vertical interval tightened when it no longer contributed useful hierarchy.
- Built an experimental eight-control, two-row selector and added decisions 06, 07, and 08. The decision sequence ultimately became Modern, Gorgeous, Smooth, User-friendly, Responsive, Cohesive, Adaptable, and Satisfying, with compact-only entries and explicit empty placeholder states where product content remains forthcoming.
- Reworked decision prose into controlled rows. Modern became Always sleek, Always streamlined, NEVER, Sleep-inducing; User-friendly uses Quickly legible, Instantly understandable, IMMEDIATELY, Actionable; Responsive emphasizes PIECE; and the later entries use NEVER or CONSIDER as the large third row where appropriate.
- Matched the ordinary description rows to the landing hero eyebrow style and the large emphasis row to the hero developer-headline face, while preserving the established white/gray hierarchy. The emphasized terms became uppercase, heavy, and underlined; line-height was normalized so underline metrics did not create uneven row spacing.
- Swapped the complete children of decisions 03 and 04 when the content order changed, not merely their selector labels. Added Android-specific phone framing so the 01, 03, and 05-era portrait captures used source-appropriate screen geometry without clipping.
- Let phone frames consume sixty percent of the right-side device region, matched inner card padding to outer margins, and standardized top/bottom content intervals. Tablet media retained its distinct full-width presentation.
- Borrowed the active UI Foundations / UX Product Flow gradient language from the Alla Vostra project page for selectors, title bridges, and large cards. Inactive controls inherited reduced-opacity background and type treatment, with noodles masked while passing beneath their occupied zones.
- Committed this substantial portrait redesign as 4e17af1 after repeated typography, spacing, opacity, device-fit, and connector experiments.

Work Completed - Responsive Eight-Entry Carousel

- Discarded the separate legacy desktop philosophy presentation and promoted the compact card system into the shared responsive implementation. The same decision model now expands from one column through two columns to three columns at 630px and 980px boundaries aligned with the landing case-study behavior.
- Added reusable previous and next arrow buttons with pointer capture, keyboard Enter/Space handling, pressed-state surfaces, a 420ms hold delay, and 180ms repeat cadence. A short click advances one decision; continued hold rotates through the full circular list.
- Adapted visible decision ordering by breakpoint. One-column mode shows the focused decision, two-column mode shows the focus plus its next sibling, and three-column mode shows previous, active, and next around the center focal stack.
- Replaced the earlier 2 x 4 grid with a carousel control model while retaining all eight decisions and wraparound order. Header names and complete card children advance together, eliminating the earlier risk that a number changed without its media or copy.
- Matched active and inactive stack surfaces to the active/inactive case-study cards, removed the outermost parent card around the full philosophy system, and ensured inactive siblings use one coherent reduced-opacity state rather than leaving bright child elements inside a dim parent.
- Forced all large cards to the height of the tallest entry in their breakpoint state, aligned every large background number to the same vertical reference, and supplied background numerals to placeholder stacks that previously had none.
- Adjusted the active number selector to the width of its associated title region while allowing neighboring selectors to surrender width, then refined inactive selector weight and opacity. Transition styling was stripped from the inactive descendants that had briefly flashed brighter during navigation.
- Preserved real phone/tablet content, project links, placeholders, and description styling inside each responsive column. The old wide-only SVG decision canvas no longer controls the desktop experience.
- Committed the responsive carousel rebuild as 627dfd4, replacing the portrait-only experiment with the final one-, two-, and three-column structural foundation.

Work Completed - Motion-Powered Desktop 3D Scene

- Activated the already-installed motion/react dependency for the three-column desktop mode only. Each complete stack - selector, title, large card, media, and typography - lives inside one keyed Motion wrapper so content remains ordinary React/CSS and can still be edited without rebuilding a canvas or WebGL scene.
- Added an 800px perspective track with a 50% / 42% perspective origin. Previous and next stacks rotate approximately -32 and +32 degrees, scale to 0.98, and render at 0.5 opacity while the active stack remains front-facing, full scale, and fully opaque.

- Used a spring transition with stiffness 180, damping 24, and mass 0.85. Reduced-motion preference disables rotation and scaling so the three columns stay flat while active/inactive opacity continues to communicate state.
- Removed AnimatePresence-style exit accumulation after rapid hold navigation revealed four to seven simultaneous outgoing stacks. The final keyed layout keeps exactly three scene stacks and lets Motion interpolate role changes without retaining obsolete children.
- Corrected the post-navigation alignment defect by moving role-specific transform origins into enforced CSS. Previous rotates around its inner right edge, active remains centered, and next rotates around its inner left edge; this removed the stale center pivot that had expanded one settled gap from 18px to roughly 79px.
- Increased inter-stack spacing by fifty percent, from 18px to 27px, while keeping both settled inactive-to-active gaps equal before and after previous/next navigation.
- Made inactive selector boxes use the active selector's underlying width before perspective compression. The left inactive selector retains an outward-descending clipped top edge; the right inactive selector's top trim was deliberately released in the accepted state.
- Reorganized each desktop top row into a 128 x 128 square number quadrant beside an equally tall header panel. The square consumes horizontal title space, the header uses the remainder after the established gap, and the original 28px interval below the row remains intact.
- Increased visible header-name typography by twenty percent to a rendered 31.104px at the 1440px validation width. A stale Turbopack stylesheet initially concealed this change until generated cache was moved aside and the detached development server was restarted cleanly.

Work Completed - Whole-Stack Interaction and Hit Testing

- Made every inactive left/right stack a carousel target rather than limiting navigation to its number button. Clicking the header, large card, description, image, project attribution, horizontal control gap, or vertical row gap now rotates that decision into the active center.
- Moved the inactive-stack handler to React's capture phase, prevents the default child action, and stops propagation before selecting the requested decision. This ensures an inactive project link first activates its stack instead of navigating away; once centered, the active link retains its normal project-route behavior.
- Diagnosed 3D hit-testing when Chrome reported the transparent track as the click target even over visible transformed cards. The final CSS disables pointer events on the perspective track and explicitly restores them on each stack, allowing empty transformed regions to bubble through the intended parent.
- Kept the external triangle navigators flat and above the 3D scene. Their visual pressed/held states remain independent from the card transforms and continue to support both pointer and keyboard operation.
- Verified rapid navigation maintains exactly three stacks, wraps around all eight decisions, and does not reintroduce the earlier inactive-state brightness flash.

Work Completed - Numerals, Copy, and Section Framing

- Changed large background labels from split 01 through 08 pairs to the significant digits 1 through 8. Selector controls retain their two-digit labels, so carousel position remains explicit while the card background becomes a stronger decorative field.
- Doubled the large numeral font scale from the previous 67.5cqi system to 135cqi, with a 445.5px minimum and 945px cap, and centered the single digit horizontally and vertically across the complete large card rather than aligning it only to the foreground paragraph.
- Preserved the existing green reverse-gradient and top-to-bottom mask treatment so the oversized numeral remains a background layer shared with the card surface rather than competing with copy and device imagery.
- Kept foreground text, project context, phone/tablet frames, and card padding unchanged while removing the measurement effect that had previously positioned two separate digits around the description block.
- Expanded the landing section subtitle from Less 'UI' - More 'You-I' to Less 'UI' - More 'You-I': The Sacred Principles That Undergird My Every Design, retaining the existing section-heading style and anchor.
- Retained title-only header panels after a brief numbered-header experiment. The square selector owns 01 through 08; adjacent headers show Modern, Gorgeous, Smooth, User-friendly, Responsive, Cohesive, Adaptable, or Satisfying without redundant numeric prefixes.

Work Completed - Local Preview, Cache, and Documentation Continuity

- Maintained the local Next.js preview at 127.0.0.1:3000 through the iterative landing-page work. Browser checks used the installed Google Chrome binary through Playwright rather than relying only on source inspection.
- Cleared generated Next.js state when the live stylesheet remained at 25.92px after the source had been raised by twenty percent. The old .next directory was moved to temporary storage, the orphaned prior next-server process was terminated, and one clean detached portfolio-dev session was left serving the site.

- Rechecked the loaded stylesheet after restart and observed the new header rule plus 31.104px rendered label text at 1440px. The stale server instance was removed without deleting source, worklogs, or project assets.
- Refreshed portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt after the four source commits. The generated snapshot now contains 17,974 lines and approximately 583 KB of current source, asset inventory, Git state, and all forty-nine earlier PDF worklogs.

Committed Source Sequence

- 137edaf - Refined the Slim Portrait Hero and Proof Stats. Centered the quote and profile identity, rebalanced portrait spacing, expanded the four proof zones, and added responsive label measurement and alignment.
- 4e17af1 - Redesigned the portrait UI/UX philosophy showcase. Added the title bridge and full-card underlay, expanded the selector to eight decisions, restyled decision copy, corrected device frames, and refined noodle/inactive behavior.
- 627dfd4 - Reworked the landing page UI/UX philosophy carousel. Replaced the former desktop layout with shared one-, two-, and three-column carousel variants, added held arrow navigation, normalized eight entries and card heights, and removed navigation-state flashing.
- 71277ce - Enhanced the landing page UI/UX philosophy carousel with 3D interactions. Added Motion/CSS perspective, corrected transform pivots, rebuilt selector/header geometry, enabled complete inactive-stack navigation, centered simplified numerals, and expanded the subtitle.
- The four commits form one continuous landing-page pass: first stabilizing the narrow hero and proof metrics, then rebuilding the philosophy content system, then generalizing it across breakpoints, and finally layering desktop depth and direct manipulation onto the accepted responsive structure.

Validation Summary

- Ran npm run check during the documentation pass; TypeScript completed successfully with no emitted files.
- Confirmed /, /projects/alla-vostra, /projects/cinerific, /aboutdev, and /articles all returned HTTP 200 from the clean detached local server.
- Used Playwright at 1440 x 1000, 760 x 1000, and 390 x 844. The philosophy section resolved to three Motion stacks at desktop, two flat columns at tablet portrait, and one flat column at slim portrait, matching the intended breakpoint model.
- At 1440px, measured the active selector and header as 128px tall, the active number quadrant as 128 x 128, the inactive stacks at 0.5 opacity, and the active stack at opacity 1. Previous and next reported opposing matrix3d rotations while active reported no transform.
- Clicked the right inactive stack through a horizontal gap and confirmed the active decision advanced from 01 to 02 while the scene retained exactly three stacks. Separate earlier checks covered title, large-card, vertical-gap, and nested-link targets.
- Emulated prefers-reduced-motion: reduce and confirmed all three desktop stacks reported transform: none.
- Measured all four proof-stat zones at equal width in each test viewport: 294.25px at 1440px, 180.25px at 760px, and 96.75px at 390px.
- Confirmed the current data contains all eight ordered philosophy decisions, including placeholder states for 02, 03, and 08, Alla Vostra phone content, Cinerific tablet content, project routes, and compact-only decisions 06 through 08.
- Confirmed main and origin/main both resolve to 71277ce before snapshot and PDF generation. The only tracked working-tree delta before creating this PDF was the customary refreshed project snapshot.

Files Touched and Artifacts

- app/ProofStats.tsx - added client-side value/label measurement, adaptive one-/two-/three-line rendering, font readiness, ResizeObserver handling, equal-zone alignment support, and accessible complete labels.
- app/UiUxDecisionShowcase.tsx - expanded the reusable decision model, rebuilt responsive carousel rendering, added shared arrow controls and hold behavior, introduced Motion role animation and reduced-motion support, simplified background digits, and captured whole-stack inactive clicks.
- app/page.tsx - expanded and reordered UI/UX decisions, added placeholders and compact-only entries, revised descriptions and device mappings, and lengthened the Philosophy subtitle.
- app/globals.css - refined slim portrait hero/proof geometry, introduced large-card and description treatments, created one-/two-/three-column carousel styling, added the desktop 3D scene, corrected pivots and hit testing, and finalized selector/header/numeral typography.
- portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt - regenerated through ./read_project.sh to record final committed application state 71277ce, current assets and configuration, Git context, and the forty-nine prior root-level Portfolio worklogs.
- portfolio_worklog_october7.pdf - created as the first October 7 Portfolio worklog at the repository root using the established no-Part filename.

Follow-Up Context

- The Motion/CSS 3D scene is intentionally restricted to min-width 981px. One- and two-column variants remain flat and should not inherit desktop perspective rules.
- Each desktop scene must contain exactly three keyed stacks. Reintroducing exit-presence retention can accumulate obsolete stacks during click-and-hold navigation and should be tested under rapid repetition.
- Transform origins are enforced by role in CSS because Motion's layout projection previously retained a centered inline origin after an active card became inactive. Removing those role rules can recreate asymmetric settled gaps.
- The perspective track deliberately uses pointer-events: none while each stack restores pointer-events: auto. This is required for clickable empty gaps; reverting it can make the track plane intercept visible-card clicks.
- Inactive-stack click handling runs in the capture phase and cancels nested actions before focusing the stack. Active project links are intentionally left functional once their card reaches the center.
- The top desktop number quadrant and title panel are both 128px tall, with a preserved 28px gap before the large card. The left inactive selector keeps its clipped descending edge; the right inactive selector intentionally has no top trim.
- Large background numbers display 1 through 8 while carousel selectors display 01 through 08. The single digits are centered across the entire card and should remain behind all foreground content.
- Decisions 02, 03, and 08 are intentional placeholders. Decisions 01, 06, and 07 use Alla Vostra phone-oriented content; decisions 04 and 05 use Cinerific tablet content. Future assets should be added through the decision data rather than breakpoint-specific markup.
- ProofStats depends on live font and element measurement. Changes to value typography, card padding, or portrait margins should be checked at 390px and adjacent narrow widths so the selected line mode still prevents edge overflow.
- As with prior Portfolio work, ask for the commit message before committing or pushing the refreshed snapshot or this PDF unless the user explicitly supplies a message and requests that operation.

Output Artifact

- Created /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio/portfolio_worklog_october7.pdf as the latest daily worklog for Wednesday, October 7, 2026, following the established month-name, non-zero-padded day, and no-Part first-record naming convention.
- Produced an unencrypted US Letter, PDF 1.4 document using Helvetica and Helvetica-Bold with Codex title, subject, author, creator, and producer metadata.
- Preserved the established dense technical narrative, mature section ordering, repeated dated page footer, and end-of-document continuity notes used by the recent Portfolio worklog series.
- Source state reviewed: 71277ce2a8aa36241e59bf1b4f816881290e7888 on main and origin/main before snapshot and PDF generation.
- No application-source change, source commit, push, manual deployment, Hostinger synchronization, or production publish was performed as part of generating this PDF artifact.